with a modem, 71.67% were sold with a network adapter, 4.96% were sold with a zip drive and 0.99% were sold with a monitor. All the main characteristics are summarized in Table 1.

For our analysis, it is useful to have transaction prices also for brand new computers which were sold by Dell to end-users through the Internet. We obtained pricelists for new computers that were sold directly by Dell during the same period. We calculated the price for different model configurations varying CPU frequencies, RAM amounts, hard disk capacities and optical devices. This method generated prices for 170 different configurations, 128 of them were Optiplex and the rest were Dimension. We added these to our sample, setting the age equal to zero. Therefore, the final desktop sample contains 876 observations.

We followed the same methodology for notebooks. We obtained data for 2430 notebooks, but only 599 had service tags. The newest computer was shipped on 31 October 2003 and the oldest on 14 May 1998. The computers' prices range from a minimum of $42 to a maximum of $1425 and the average price is $446.17. The CPU speed varies from 233

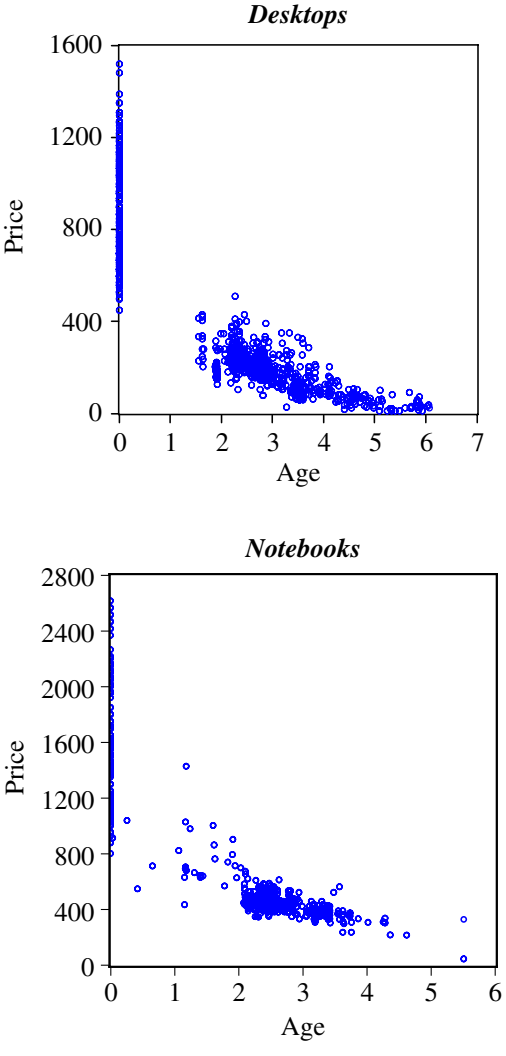


Figure 2. Age and price scatter plot.
Note: Age is measured in years.